

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1494

By Reneau

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of World War II veteran Russell LeRoy Pickett upon the dedication of a historical marker in his honor.

WHEREAS, our nation was conceived by individuals who were willing to sacrifice their personal safety and concerns to ensure our individual and collective freedom, and the Volunteer State is especially proud to be the home of so many valiant men and women who have performed above and beyond the call of duty; and

WHEREAS, the citizens of Tennessee have, throughout the years, been called upon to take up arms against the enemies of this great nation, risking their lives and leaving their loved ones behind to honorably safeguard the freedoms and liberties guaranteed to all citizens of these United States and vanquishing those who threaten our way of life; and

WHEREAS, while the heroic deeds of Tennesseans have been extolled throughout the history of our State and nation, the distinguished military service of every proud Tennessean should be illuminated, shared, and properly honored; and

WHEREAS, one such individual was Russell LeRoy Pickett, a gallant veteran of the United States Army, whose memory is being honored on May 2, 2026, with the dedication of a State historical marker at the Veterans Park in Soddy-Daisy; and

WHEREAS, a resident of Daisy, Mr. Pickett was a World War II veteran who was among the first to land on Omaha Beach on D-Day, June 6, 1944; and

WHEREAS, at the time of his death on August 2, 2020, Mr. Pickett was thought to have been one of the last survivors of this brave, historically important group; and

WHEREAS, while no offering can properly relay our gratitude for Mr. Pickett's bravery and dedication to preserving the blessed freedom that is inseparable from our American

heritage and ideals, it is most appropriate that this testament to his legacy and our shared history be erected in his honor; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of World War II veteran Russell LeRoy Pickett on the dedication of a State historical marker in his honor.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.